

Furman University Engineering Club Constitution

Article I: Name

The formal name of this organization shall be the Furman University Engineering Club (FUEC).

Article II: Purpose

The purpose of FUEC shall be to help Furman students of all skill levels learn and apply engineering skills in a fun and hands-on environment. Skills such as working with 3D printers, learning to use various power tools, learning to solder, using Arduino microcontrollers, and coding in the Python or C++ languages. Members are welcome to pursue their own projects individually or as a group.

The central objectives of the organization are: 1) To help Furman students of all skill levels learn and apply programming and basic engineering skills in a fun and hands-on environment. 2) To facilitate student pursuit of their own engineering/robotics-related projects. 3) To engage in collaborative work with Furman faculty to design and implement systems that improve the university and the world. 4) To send teams to local and national engineering and robotics competitions as part of encouraging and building students' skills in engineering.

Article III: Affiliations

FUEC is affiliated with the Physics department here, but membership is open to students of any major. In addition, part of the club's goals include building machines, robots, or items to participate in engineering and robotics-type competitions.

Article IV: Membership

In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.

For specific teams that attend competitions, membership is limited to those selected by the officers and advisor, but every member of the club is able to apply.

Article V: Officers

The club will have a President, Vice President, Treasurer, and Secretary. To serve in any role one must have been a member of the club for at least one year and must be elected by a majority of all members. Each position will last the school year and officers will be elected each fall.

Article VI: Advisor

The club advisor's role is to help coordinate workshops, help find speakers, and to assist the club in administrative matters that require an advisor or faculty member present.

Article VII: Meetings

Meetings for the general club will be held at least once per month. Meetings for smaller teams or projects within the club will meet more often as needed.

Article VIII: Finance

FUEC will receive funding from Furman's Student Government Association, grants for robotics and engineering, from the Physics Department, and from local engineering firms.

Article IX: Amendments

This constitution and by-laws may be amended by a 2/3 majority vote of those voting when a majority of the club membership is present.

ARTICLE X: Statement of Compliance with Campus Regulations

This organization shall comply with all university and campus policies and regulations and local, state, and federal laws.

BYLAWS

Article I: Membership

Every person who wants to be a member of the club may be. This general membership allows them to participate in workshops and lessons, listen to speakers, and have access to the Student Workshop (Plyler 208 and 210)

For specific teams or projects, there is no specific process for selecting members but they must be confirmed by at least two officers and the leader on that project. If the team involves competitions, dues can be collected if needed from the members of the competition team.

Members may be removed from competitive teams and projects at the discretion of the leader of the project and at least two officers.

A member can be removed from the general club by an ad hoc committee of officers and at least three other members of the clubs, any person selected for this ad hoc committee must recuse themselves from it if they have direct involvement or connections to the member in question. In addition, there must be a documented reason for any removal, such as a violation of Furman's Code of Conduct.

Article II: Selection of Officers

Officers will be elected each fall and their term will last until the subsequent fall semester.

a. President: The president or his approved representative shall serve as liaison to other student organizations as well as faculty and staff. The president is also responsible for planning/coordinating meetings and activities, as well as serving as an educator/mentor to less experienced programmers/electricians. The president will be tasked with guiding the club through various projects and ensuring the success of the same. The President is also in charge of keeping track of projects, teams, and current uses of the Student Workshop.

b. Vice-president: The vice president shall primarily serve as a social coordinator, planning activities and ensuring communication and distribution of information effectively throughout the club.

c. Treasurer: The treasurer will manage financial matters in the club, including applying for grants and managing funds for different projects or workshops.

d. Secretary: Secretaries shall serve as representatives of the larger organization in policy discussion, as part of this, the secretary is in charge of a bi-weekly email sent to all members of the club outlining any upcoming events for those two weeks.

Recall of Officers:

Officers are subject to recall for malfeasance in office. Malfeasance shall be defined as:

1. An inability to perform the requirements of office
2. Willfully disobeying Furman University Rules and Regulations governing student organizations
3. Breaching the Student Code of Conduct
4. Mismanaging club funds
5. Failure to effectively represent the broader club membership

Recall procedures may be initiated by any member, but must be passed by a 3/5 majority. The officer in question will be suspended from their duties and the remaining officers will pick a temporary replacement, if needed, to fill in before the next meeting.

In the event of a vacancy, the club will vote on a member to fill that role at the next meeting. This new officer will only serve the rest of the term the vacancy is filling.

Article III: Selection of Advisor

An advisor is selected by current club leadership and confirmed by a 2/3 vote of the club membership.

The process for removing an advisor is the same as the process for removing a club officer.

Article IV: Committees

If a member only needs use of space in the Student Workshop then they only need to inform the President. If a member is establishing their own project with equipment or supplies in that room then they must get permission from the President and Treasurer.

To establish a competition team, a member must have a discussion with all the officers and coordinate with the treasurer for any funding.

An ad hoc committees can be established in situations already outlined above.

Article V: Rules of Order

Internal conflicts are resolved at the monthly full membership meetings. If there is matter that needs to be voted on not outlined above, then it can be resolved by a majority vote of the members at this

monthly meeting. Any foreseeable issues must be brought to the officers in writing before the monthly club meeting.

Article VI: Amendments

The bylaws may be amended at a monthly general club meeting by a 2/3 vote.

This amendment must be brought to the officers ahead of time, so that the change can be told to the general club members ahead of the vote.